THE $0 WAY + THE SANDCASTLES WAY

My *Topic Leaderboard* prompt

Find the topics your niche already proved, then make your own take. Prices and plans checked on 21 Oct 2026.



START HERE

What a *topic leaderboard* is

Your competitors' videos, ranked by how far each one beat that creator's usual views. When a video does 10× the usual, the **topic** did the work — so you make your own take on it.

THE SCORE

OUTLIER SCORE	views ÷ the creator's usual views (the median of their recent videos)
10×	500K views on an account that usually gets 50K
PROVEN	the same topic spikes (3× or more) for 2+ creators
MAYBE LUCK	one creator, one spike — it could just be his audience

COPY THE TOPIC, NOT THE VIDEO

TAKE	the topic, the hook pattern, the format
LEAVE	their script, their footage, their face
ADD	your example, your numbers, your city

WHERE THE IDEA COMES FROM

@kallawaymarketing's Topic Leaderboard carousel (5 Oct 2026). Kallaway built Sandcastles. Everything here is my own version — my prompts, my test. It is not his skill file.

TWO WAYS

$0, or Sandcastles

Same leaderboard. The free way takes screenshots; the paid way watches for you.

THE $0 WAY	
COSTS	**$0**
NEEDS	any Claude plan, even Free — no plugin
DATA	screenshots of each creator's Reels, Shorts or TikTok tab
TIME	about 10 minutes a week
MISSES	daily watching, transcripts, hook breakdowns

THE SANDCASTLES WAY	
COSTS	Pro **$49/mo**, or $39/mo billed yearly. No free plan, and subscriptions aren't refunded
NEEDS	any Claude plan — Free allows one custom connector
DATA	live Reels, TikToks and Shorts from up to 150 creators
TIME	one question each morning
CREDITS	questions are free; 1 credit per new video it breaks down (100 a month on Pro)

MY ADVICE

Run the $0 way for two weeks. If you open it every week, the paid one saves you the screenshots. If you don't, you just saved $49.

STEP 1 · BOTH WAYS

Pick *10 creators*

Your watchlist decides what the board can find. Keep it in your niche and your language.

Who to pick

- **5 big names** in your niche — they show which topics are hot.
- **5 creators your size** — a 10× hit there is a topic *you* can win, not just a famous face.
- Same audience as yours: same niche, same language, same country if you can.
- Mix platforms if you like — Reels, Shorts and TikTok all show views.
- Swap out anyone off-topic every week or two.

SANDCASTLES SAYS THE SAME

"Don't overlook smaller creators: Smaller, niche creators often give more targeted and actionable ideas than large channels." — Sandcastles' watchlist guide. They suggest starting with 5–10 channels for a niche and growing to 30–40.

THE $0 WAY

Screenshots + Claude

2 Screenshot each creator's video tab

Open their profile → **Reels** (or **Shorts**, or TikTok's videos). Every tile shows its views. Skip the pinned ones at the top — they're old hits. Take 2–3 screenshots each, about 30 videos.

3 Paste this into Claude with the screenshots

COPY THIS PROMPT — THE $0 LEADERBOARD

```
You are my content researcher. I'm attaching screenshots of the
Reels / Shorts / TikTok tab of a few creators in my niche. Each
tile shows a view count.

1. For each creator, read every tile's views and its cover text.
Write "?" if a number is unreadable. Never guess.
2. Each creator's usual views = the median of their videos in
my screenshots.
3. Outlier score = a video's views ÷ that creator's usual views.
4. Make a leaderboard of the top 10 by outlier score: rank,
creator, what the video is about, views, their usual, outlier
score (one decimal).
5. Group the top 10 into topics. A topic is PROVEN if it hits 3×
or more for 2+ different creators, MAYBE LUCK if only one.
6. For each PROVEN topic: one line on why it worked (hook,
format, timing), then 3 angles I could make for my audience: [who
you make videos for]. My own take, never their script.

Show the leaderboard as a table, then the topics. Keep it short.
```

Before you trust the board, ask Claude to list the views it read, and fix any it misread. On my test it read **10 of 10** right.

MY TEST · 21 OCT 2026

What my *$0 board* found

3 creators' latest public YouTube Shorts: Kallaway (30), Vaibhav Sisinty (30) and Nick Saraev (19, all he has listed).

Topic leaderboard · *my $0 test*

3 creators' latest YouTube Shorts · outlier = views ÷ their usual · 21 Oct 2026

1	**Kallaway** This is the AI Agent Audit Process every business should run to “agentify their workflow”	95×	929K ÷ 9.8K
2	**Kallaway** I just built an AI Video Researcher Agent with Microsoft Copilot Studio	95×	926K ÷ 9.8K
3	**Kallaway** The easiest way to build AI agents for your business	24×	239K ÷ 9.8K
4	**Vaibhav Sisinty** This Indian Startup Did What the US & China Navy COULDN’T!	22×	1M ÷ 44.5K
5	**Vaibhav Sisinty** Mukesh Ambani Is Selling a Computer That DOESN'T EXIST!	6×	273K ÷ 44.5K
6	**Vaibhav Sisinty** GPT-6 Astra is NOT AGI... Here's the Real Truth!	6×	264K ÷ 44.5K
7	**Nick Saraev** Why Saturation Doesn't Matter	5×	52K ÷ 10K
8	**Nick Saraev** AI automation is just like any other business	5×	48K ÷ 10K
9	**Vaibhav Sisinty** Apple Just Convinced Me to Switch Back to iPhone!	4×	193K ÷ 44.5K
10	**Vaibhav Sisinty** My Apology to Mark Zuckerberg... Meta Is Back!	4×	169K ÷ 44.5K

My own test, top 10. Views as the Shorts tabs show them; usual = each creator's median.

WHAT IT FOUND

AI agents and automation for business: Kallaway's top 3 (up to 95×) and Nick Saraev's #2 (4.8×). Two creators, so it's **Proven.** Vaibhav Sisinty's 22× "Indian startup beat the navies" Short is one creator, one spike — I'd watch for a second before filming it.

THE SANDCASTLES WAY

Connect it to Claude

Claude can't open Instagram by itself. The Sandcastles connector is the bridge: it reads Reels, TikToks and Shorts for Claude.

2 Get Sandcastles Pro

The connector needs Pro, Visionary or Titan — Starter ($5) doesn't include it. Pro is $49/mo, or $39/mo billed yearly.

3 Connect it

Pick the one that matches where you use Claude (Sandcastles' setup guide).

CLAUDE APP	open claude.ai/directory/sandcastles → Connect → sign in with Sandcastles
BY HAND	Settings → Connectors → Add custom connector → name Sandcastles, URL `https://mcp.sandcastles.ai/` → Add → Connect
CLAUDE CODE	`/plugin marketplace add sandcastles-ai/plugins`, then `/plugin install sandcastles@sandcastles`

4 Add your 10 creators

In Sandcastles → **Channels**, or just ask Claude: "Add these channels to my Sandcastles watchlist: ...". Adding from chat doesn't use credits.

THE SANDCASTLES WAY

Each morning, ask this

5 Paste this into Claude

COPY THIS PROMPT — THE SANDCASTLES LEADERBOARD

```
Use Sandcastles. Build my topic leaderboard for the last 7 days.

1. Search my watchlist's videos from the last 7 days and rank
them by outlier score. Top 10: rank, creator, what it's about,
views, outlier score, Sandcastles link.
2. Group them into topics. A topic is PROVEN if it beats its
creator's usual by 3× or more for 2+ creators, MAYBE LUCK if
only one.
3. For each PROVEN topic: the hook and format that carried it.
Use what Sandcastles has already analysed; don't analyse new
videos unless I say so (each one costs a credit).
4. Then 3 angles for my audience: [who you make videos for]. My
own take, never their script.

Show the leaderboard as a table, then the topics.
```

GOOD TO KNOW

RUNS ITSELF?	No — you ask. Sandcastles' automation rules can auto-analyse breakouts (3 a day by default, 1 credit each).
BUILT IN	the plugin also has `/videos-watchlist`, `/topics` and `/video-suggest` — handy, but they don't do the 2-creator check.
STATUS	I tested the $0 version. This one runs on the same scoring but needs a Sandcastles account, so I haven't run it on mine yet.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Fixes for the usual problems

"I CAN'T OPEN INSTAGRAM"	True — stock Claude can't. Use screenshots (the $0 way) or the Sandcastles connector.
NUMBERS LOOK OFF	Ask Claude to list every view it read. Fix the misreads, then rerun.
OLD HITS ON TOP	Pinned posts. Skip them in your screenshots.
ONE CREATOR WINS EVERYTHING	That's one audience. Wait for a second creator before you film.
SANDCASTLES MISSING IN CLAUDE	Check you're on Pro or higher, then reconnect in Settings → Connectors (Claude Code: run `/mcp`).
TOPICS FEEL OFF-NICHE	Your watchlist is too wide. Swap in 5 creators your size.

THEN MAKE IT YOURS

Take the proven topic, find your own example, and say it the way only you would. That's the whole point: data picks the topic, you make the video.



Copy the topic, *not the video*

Prices and plans checked on Sandcastles' and Claude's own pages on 21 Oct 2026.

— Abhay